ICD-10 Clinical Coding Guidelines & Diagnostic Specificity Rules

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Official Healthcare & Insurance Knowledge Document

SECTION: Diagnostic Specificity Rules for Primary Conditions

Clinicians and coders must specify laterality, severity, and etiology: Code M17.11 for primary unilateral osteoarthritis of right knee; Code M17.12 for left knee. Code K80.00 for calculus of gallbladder with acute cholecystitis without obstruction. Code I21.9 for acute myocardial infarction, unspecified. Code M51.26 for other intervertebral disc displacement, lumbar region. Non-specific codes such as 'knee pain' or 'abdominal colic' without underlying etiology will trigger claim rejection.